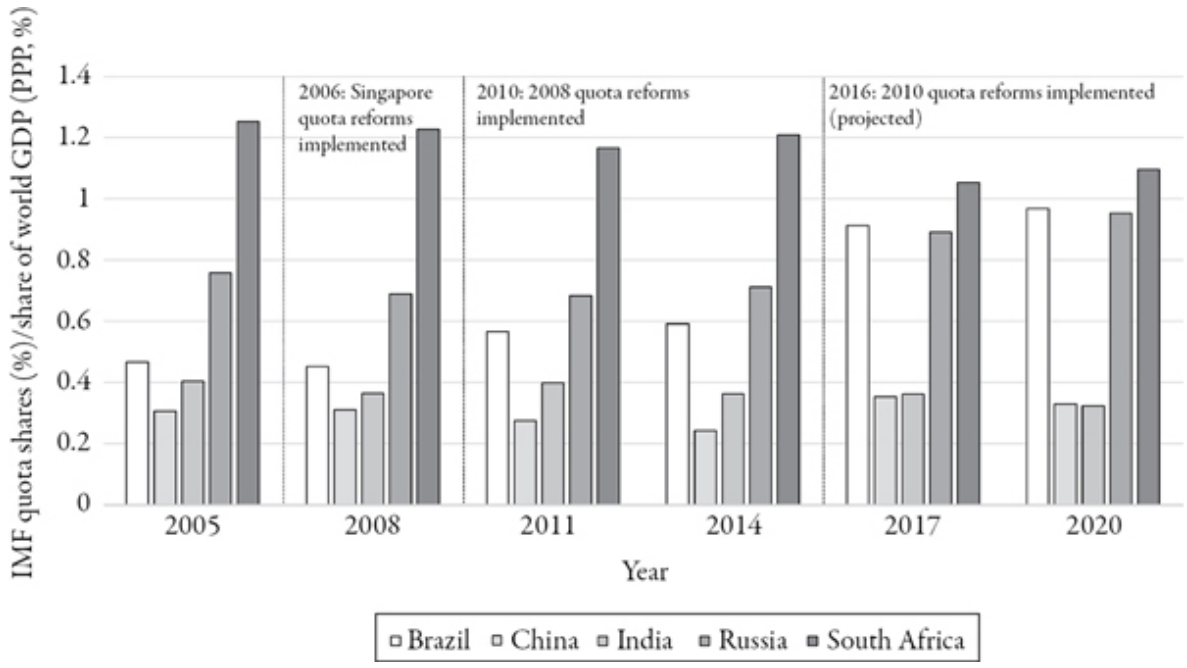


FIGURE 3.6 Ratio of IMF Quota Shares (%) to Share of World GDP (PPP, %): Individual BRICS, 2005–2020

Source: IMF World Economic Outlook, April 2016 update; C. Roberts calculations.

As the IMF debates changing the formula in the 15th Quota Reform, the BRICS are gearing up to lobby in pursuit of their self-interests. Russian economic research shows that giving greater weight to the country's proportion of the world economy and to international reserves will increase the BRICS' share more than what was achieved in the 2010 package of quota reforms, where the combined BRICS share only rose from 10.71 percent to 14.8 percent. One calculation by prominent government experts shows that an increase in the share of reserves in the quota calculation up to 30 percent, while commensurately reducing the level of openness, leads to a total increase in the BRICS quota to 25.41 percent. However, in this case, the United States would lose its veto rights and European countries would see their quotas reduced from 30.01 percent to 22.8 percent.[32] The rest of the BRICS have broadly supported approaches to changing the formula that emphasize such factors.[33] Western analysts have made similar observations, and numerous studies have been written about the distributional effects of reforming voting shares and formulas.[34] Of course, if the BRICS' economies decline, these adjustments will be of little use.